

# PALESA DIBAKWANE DOOMS

Speaker | Moderator | Master of Ceremonies |  
Television Presenter | Communication Coach



# MEET PALESA

Palesa Dibakwane Dooms is a South African speaker, communication coach, television presenter and the Founder of Unforgettable Speakers – School of Excellence.

She helps professionals, graduates, entrepreneurs and emerging leaders communicate with confidence, position themselves effectively and become more visible in the spaces where opportunities are created.

Her work focuses on the conversations that can change the direction of a person's career: introducing yourself, attending an interview, speaking in a meeting, presenting your ideas, networking with decision-makers and confidently communicating the value you bring.

Having built a career across corporate South Africa, television, speaking and entrepreneurship, Palesa understands that qualifications and experience are not always enough. People must also know how to express what they know, communicate their potential and make a credible impression.

Her approach is practical, relatable and rooted in the realities of the South African workplace. She speaks honestly about confidence, unemployment, career transitions, limited professional networks and the difficulty many talented people experience when trying to communicate in high-pressure environments.

Whether speaking to students, graduates, professionals, entrepreneurs or corporate teams, Palesa equips audiences with tools they can apply immediately.



# SIGNATURE SPEAKING TOPICS



## Speak to Get the Job

*A practical and confidence-building talk for graduates, job seekers and professionals preparing for their next opportunity.*

*Palesa explores how to communicate your value before, during and after the interview process. The session helps audiences understand how to introduce themselves, structure interview answers, speak about their experience and avoid underselling their potential.*

*Key themes include:*

- *Answering “Tell me about yourself”*
- *Communicating your experience clearly*
- *Preparing for difficult interview questions*
- *Speaking confidently when nervous*
- *Showing potential when experience is limited*
- *Asking intelligent questions during an interview*
- *Creating a memorable professional impression*

# SIGNATURE SPEAKING TOPICS



## Your Qualification Cannot Speak for You

*Many capable people have qualifications, experience and potential but struggle to articulate what they know.*

*This keynote explores the communication gap that often exists between being competent and being recognised as competent.*

*Palesa helps audiences understand that professional growth requires more than working hard. It also requires the ability to contribute in meetings, explain ideas, speak about achievements and communicate with decision-makers.*

*The session is ideal for graduates, young professionals and employees preparing for promotion.*

# SIGNATURE SPEAKING TOPICS

## From Invisible to Unignorable

*A talk about professional visibility, personal positioning and confidently taking up space.*

*Palesa addresses the fear of speaking up, networking, sharing ideas and making oneself visible in professional environments.*

*The session challenges the belief that good work will always speak for itself and provides practical guidance on becoming known for the value you bring without becoming boastful or inauthentic.*

*Key themes include:*

- *Building professional visibility*
- *Speaking about your achievements*
- *Networking with intention*
- *Contributing confidently in meetings*
- *Communicating your professional value*
- *Becoming memorable for the right reasons*



# SIGNATURE SPEAKING TOPICS

## **Speak to Get Promoted**

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*This talk is designed for professionals who are ready for greater responsibility but may not yet be communicating at the level of the position they want.*

*Palesa explores how communication affects credibility, leadership potential and career progression.*

*The session focuses on helping professionals express ideas clearly, contribute strategically, answer questions with confidence and communicate with senior stakeholders.*

## **Confidence Is Not a Personality Type**

*Confidence is often misunderstood as something a person either naturally has or does not have.*

*In this keynote, Palesa shows audiences that communication confidence can be developed through preparation, structure, practice and self-awareness.*

*The session is especially valuable for people who experience anxiety during interviews, presentations, meetings or professional conversations.*



# SIGNATURE SPEAKING TOPICS



## How to Introduce Yourself Without Underselling Yourself

*A practical session on creating a clear, credible and memorable professional introduction.*

*Palesa teaches audiences how to speak about who they are, what they do, what they have achieved and where they are going.*

*This topic is suitable for networking events, career fairs, graduate programmes, entrepreneurship events and leadership development sessions.*

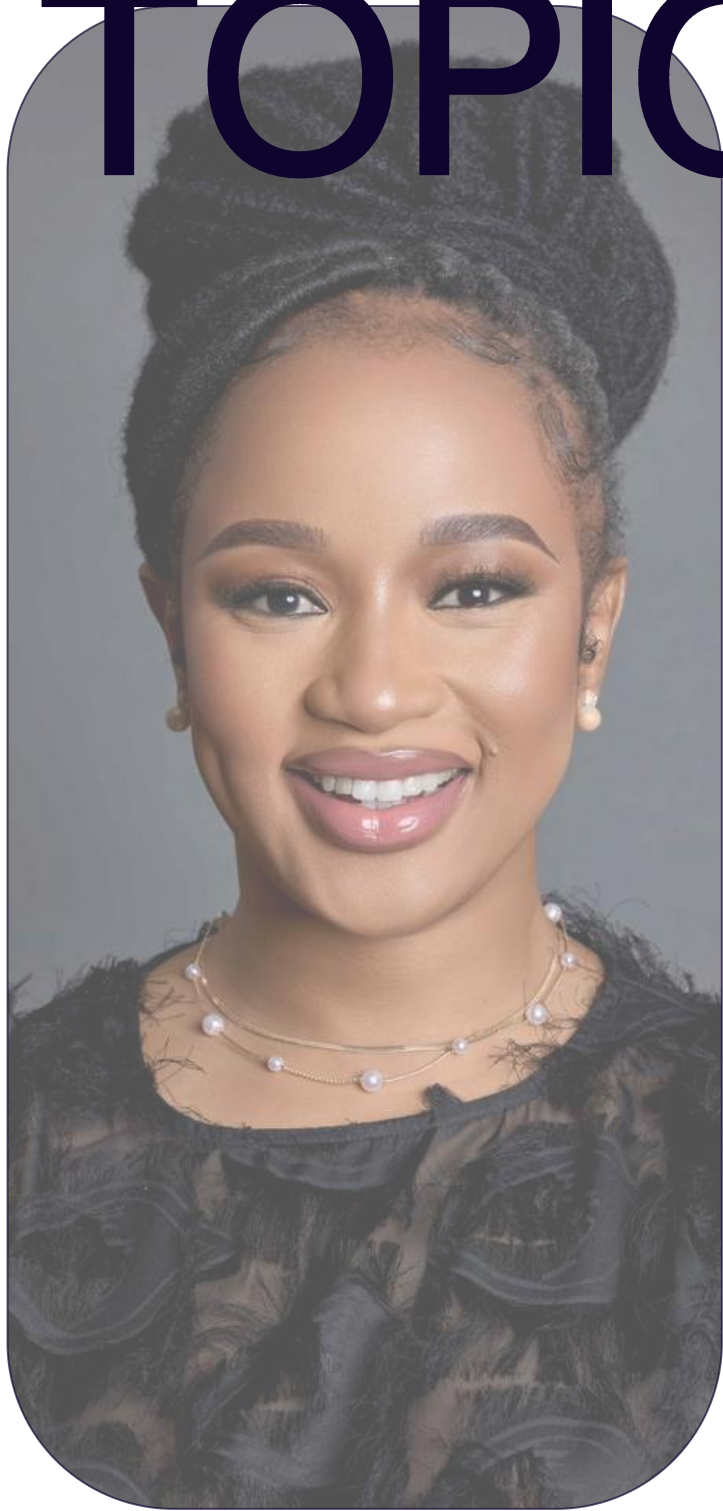
## **Job Searching in a Relationship-Driven Economy**

*Opportunities are often created through conversations, referrals and professional relationships.*

*This keynote explores how job seekers and young professionals can build networks, approach people respectfully, request career conversations and remain visible within the industries they want to enter.*

*The session encourages audiences to move beyond submitting applications and begin creating meaningful professional connections.*

# SIGNATURE SPEAKING TOPICS



## The Interview Starts Before You Enter the Room

*A talk on preparation, presence and professional reputation.*

*Palesa explains how employers begin forming impressions through applications, emails, online profiles, telephone conversations and professional conduct before the formal interview takes place.*

*The session covers communication across the full job-search journey.*

# THE AFRICAN WAY WE COMMUNICATE

Rediscovering the power of African communication.

Africa has always been rich in communication traditions storytelling, Ubuntu, oral history, community dialogue and learning through lived experience.

This keynote explores how African philosophies can strengthen modern leadership, business communication and influence, reminding audiences that our greatest communication lessons have always existed within our own cultures.



# ENTREPRENEURSHIP AND PERSONAL GROWTH TOPICS

- **FROM EMPLOYEE TO EMPLOYER**

Palesa shares her journey from corporate employment into entrepreneurship and building a growing education and communication business.

The keynote explores the emotional, financial and professional realities of starting a business, creating employment and learning to trust your own ideas.

It is an honest conversation about courage, preparation, uncertainty and building while still becoming.

- **YOUR VOICE IS PART OF YOUR PERSONAL BRAND**

This session explores how communication shapes professional reputation.

Palesa helps audiences understand how tone, language, clarity, confidence and consistency influence how others experience their personal brand.

- **STOP WAITING TO FEEL READY**

A keynote for people who continuously postpone applying, speaking, starting or making themselves visible because they do not yet feel fully prepared.

Palesa encourages audiences to recognise that readiness is often developed through action rather than achieved before action.

# MODERATOR

Palesa moderates conversations with warmth, intelligence and purpose.

Her interviewing and communication background allows her to guide discussions naturally, ask meaningful follow-up questions and ensure that both panellists and audiences remain engaged.

She is especially suited to moderating conversations on:

- Careers and employability
- Youth development
- Entrepreneurship
- Education
- Women in business
- Leadership and communication
- Personal branding
- Workplace readiness
- Skills development
- The future of work
- African leadership and identity
- Professional confidence

Palesa prepares thoroughly for every engagement and works closely with organisers to understand the audience, event objectives and desired outcomes.



# MASTER OF CEREMONIES

As a Master of Ceremonies, Palesa brings structure, professionalism, warmth and energy to an event.

She understands that an MC is not only responsible for introducing speakers. The MC must protect the programme, manage the room, maintain momentum and help create a memorable experience.

Palesa is available to host:

- Corporate conferences
- Awards ceremonies
- Career and education events
- Graduation ceremonies
- Women's events
- Leadership summits
- Business breakfasts
- Gala dinners
- Product launches
- Entrepreneurship events
- Youth development programmes
- Panel discussions

Her style is polished but approachable, making her well suited to both formal corporate environments and energetic audience-centred events.



# TELEVISION AND MEDIA PRESENTING

Palesa's television background has shaped her ability to communicate naturally with both guests and audiences.

She is comfortable presenting scripted and unscripted content, conducting interviews, facilitating discussions and translating complex information into accessible conversations.

Her presenting interests include:

- Careers and employability
- Education
- Entrepreneurship
- Personal development
- Women and leadership
- Business
- Communication
- Human-interest stories
- Youth and family development
- South African success stories

Her style is conversational, curious and grounded. She creates an environment in which guests feel comfortable while ensuring that the conversation remains focused and valuable to the audience.



# FACILITATION AND MASTERCLASSES

In addition to keynote speaking, Palesa facilitates practical learning experiences for professionals, graduates and emerging leaders.

Her workshops and masterclasses include:

- Interview preparation
- Tell Me About Yourself
- Executive and professional communication
- Presentation skills
- Speaking confidently in meetings
- Question-handling techniques
- Personal branding and professional visibility
- Networking conversations
- Career communication
- Public speaking
- Storytelling
- Articulation and message structure

Her sessions are interactive, practical and designed to help participants move from understanding communication concepts to applying them in real situations.



# WHY BOOK PALESA?



*Palesa does not speak about communication only as a theory. She teaches audiences what to say, how to structure it and how to practise it.*

*Her strength lies in making people feel seen while also challenging them to take greater responsibility for how they present themselves.*

*She brings together:*

- *Corporate experience*
- *Television and media experience*
- *Public speaking expertise*
- *Communication coaching*
- *Entrepreneurship*
- *A strong understanding of the South African employment environment*
- *A relatable and practical teaching style*

*Audiences leave with more than inspiration. They leave with language, frameworks and practical tools they can use in interviews, meetings, presentations and professional conversations.*

# PALESA'S CORE MESSAGE

*Being capable is important. Being able to communicate your capability is what helps other people recognise it.*

*Palesa's work helps people find the confidence, structure and language to speak for themselves when opportunity enters the room.*



# WATCH PALESA IN ACTION

**Moderator:**

<https://youtu.be/bOUK7aHuJGE>

**Glencore Keynote Training**

<https://youtu.be/zuKcLznXmSg>



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